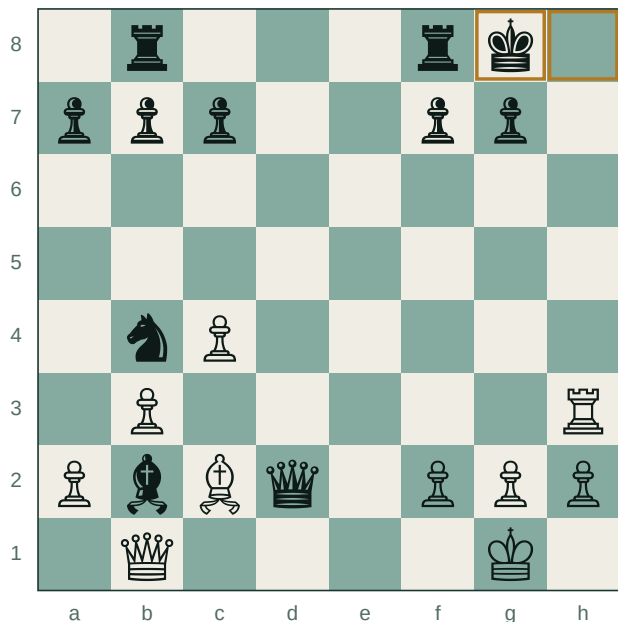


Discovered checks: White, move 21

Discovered checks

White to move



Previous move: 20...Kg8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21. Bh7+ Kh8 22. Bg8+ Qh6 23. Rxh6+ gxh6 24. Qh7#

21.Bh7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **21...Kh8**.

22.Bg8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The changed line means the rook on h3 attacks the king on h8. Recorded reply: **22...Qh6**.

23.Rxh6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the queen on h6. Recorded reply: **23...gxh6**.

24.Qh7# Mate: queen on h7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on d2 and bishop on b2. Check for tactical protection.